

Desktops from LG

LG is getting into the Desktop PC market with a manufacturing plant at Noida.



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amount of HP software that comes along with the PC. It seems excessive and although it might be useful for a few, it's the cause of most of the PC's slowdown. With the software removed, we proceeded to the tests. The Pavilion we received came set up with a 2.66 GHz Intel Core 2 Duo E2200, 2 GB of DDR2 RAM all running on a slightly older nForce 630i platform.

The setup performs well throughout the tests. The superiority of the nForce chipsets once again boost the game benchmark scores. The Pavilion A6740 is able to run Far Cry at around 84 frames per second at a resolution of 640 x 480 at minimum details. Doom 3 scored 22.6 frames per second at 800 x 600 with medium quality. The fast dual-core processor also gets a good score in the Cinebench rendering test.

The HP Pavilion A6740 sells for Rs. 38,700 which for the performance it provides isn't too shabby a price tag. Those who want a desktop PC for home use should consider this. It's more than sufficient performance for desktop applications and it can also be used for some basic gaming.

Intex Platinum PM 45431

We received one of Intex's desktops targeted at the entry-level home user called the Intex Platinum PM 45431. The desktop comes with a 19-inch display, a standard keyboard and mouse and a USB-powered set of speakers that sit flat on the table.

The case is a standard mid-sized tower. Externally, the case looks good in features and appearance as well. There is space for two optical drives. The case has a cover over the drive bay which folds open when the drive is ejected. The memory card reader is left open and has no cover so dust will get in. The cabinet panels are all really thin and very flexible.

The cabinet will get a bit noisy over time from the vibrations from the throttling fans and drives as the side panels are really thin and flex when you move them around or put any pressure on them. The cables aren't tied up as neatly as with some of the other PCs and the cables were left hanging over the CPU fan region. A scoop hangs over from the side panel on top of the processor fan. Like some other manufacturers, there is some glue stuck to the drive screws. This glue has been splattered on shabbily. The power supply cables too feel flimsy and thin. This is another PC to come with a LPT port and a serial port.

The display is simple but looks pretty good. It is an average performer. The only real complaint is the center button which is used to interface with the menus and also acts as the primary power button. It feels weak and is most likely to break or stop work if you use it a lot.

The keyboard and mouse are the other two main issues. The keyboard is an inch or so smaller than some of the other desktop PCs which might seem unnecessary. This has been done by getting rid of the spaces

in between the function keys and the numerical pad. There isn't any space left over to keep your palm on while typing. Some of the biggest annoyances are from the moving of the Insert key to the base of the keyboard and the backward slash key to the left bottom of the keyboard. The optical mouse is as tiny as a portable laptop mouse, is too light and shaped very oddly.

This PC came preinstalled with Windows XP. We ran benchmarks on it but it didn't product any spectacular score. The hard drive performance was the only respectable number of all the other scores. The performance is only so because of the configuration used. A 2.2 GHz Intel Core 2 Duo E4500 is used alongside an i945GC chipset which isn't particularly great for its graphics performance. The price for this PC is Rs. 24,900.

LG U8047-E0463

LG isn't known to be a PC brand. It is well known for its DVD drives and displays the most. LG's desktops are sold to offices but they aren't known to make enthusiast-level gaming rigs. We received two systems from LG. Both the LG PCs had similar configurations. The larger oddly named the U8047-E0463 comes with a larger 19-inch screen. There isn't a lot that makes this PC stand out.

The configuration is



LG U8047-E0463

pretty similar to the other LG. The Intel Core 2 Duo E7200 with two gigabytes of memory can handle most applications easily. Gaming might not be the thing to do with the underpowered Intel G31 chipset's graphics solution.

In benchmarks, the U8047-E0463 performs very close to the D6047-E0381 across all the benchmarks except the memory bandwidth and file transfer tests. The game benchmarks show small changes as well. The effects of the lack of memory are even more visible as memory is allocated by the system for the graphics accelerator. The pricing of this model is similar to the HP Pavilion A6740. The HP is Rs. 1300 more than the LG but also comes with a slightly processor which makes it a little faster as well.

LG D6047-E0381

For most offices, the need is of a basic every

PC that allows you to run office applications and maybe a few Internet utilities now and then. The LG D6047-E0381 is one such system and comes with a 17-inch screen with a 4:3 aspect ratio display. It's more compact than the other LG PC we tested during the test but this feels even more office oriented. This is because of the few missing components. You get no memory card reader in this PC and the chassis is smaller too. The system runs pretty cool and isn't too noisy either. There is a small blower fan placed under the case that blows air out from underneath.

The optical drive is present on the side. The interiors are pretty crowded but it's still well ventilated. It gets a little warm after a while. The performance of the system isn't so great either.

The price for this PC is Rs. 27,808 which is a lot compared to some of the other rigs. The Acer NX4440 for example comes with a larger screen, has much better performance and costs just Rs. 29,299. If you are on a tight budget, then go for the LG otherwise the Acer seems like a better deal.

Zenith Premium PC Q6600

The Zenith Premium PC Q6600 might appear as the simpleton of the pack but it is one of the heavily loaded desktops. It is powered by an Intel Core 2 Quad Q6600 process which might seem a bit dated but it is still a pretty powerful quad-core processor. To add to this, there is 8 GB of memory that comes with the system.

Zenith has only put a GeForce 7300SE on this system which isn't a lot for a system of this kind.

The layout inside is neat, the case is spacious but the only issue is the noisy case. The power supply fan in our case was creating a constant low hum. The keyboard is simple without any special ergonomic designs and the mouse too is standard. The Zenith Premium PC was the only one to come with a 22-inch screen.

The performance was where the Zenith stood out the most. The quad core processor is great for rendering and the amount of memory did too. Cinebench scores were the second best of all the desktops behind the Dell OptiPlex. It also did well in the game benchmarks where it topped in the Far Cry benchmark with 115 frames per second.

A dedicated graphics card would have done much more to the score and would be the component required to create a balanced setup for this configuration. At Rs. 42,500, it's not very expensive and makes a good system to upgrade from. A GeForce 7300SE simply doesn't cut it and replacing it with a faster graphics card would do wonders. It could then be used as a gaming desktop or even as a decent system for 3D modelers or any computer-graphics artist for that matter.

Conclusion

Of the PCs we tested, we've seen everything from simple low-power desktops to high-